

BEGINNER-FRIENDLY | STEP BY STEP | FULL CODE INCLUDED

Build a Wedding Invite Website

No experience needed. Just follow each step.
You will have a live website by the end.

Install

Setup Files

Add Music

Go Live

WHAT YOU WILL BUILD:

- ✓ A beautiful mobile wedding invite website
- ✓ Tap-to-open envelope animation at the start
- ✓ Scrolling slides for each ceremony (Mehendi, Haldi, Wedding...)
- ✓ Live countdown timer to the wedding day
- ✓ Background music that plays automatically
- ✓ A free live website link to share with guests

Install Everything

You need 3 things installed on your computer before we start.

1 Install Node.js — the engine that runs everything

Node.js lets you run JavaScript on your computer (not just in a browser). It also installs **npm** — a tool that downloads code packages for you.

TIP: Go to nodejs.org — click the big green LTS button — download and install it like any normal app.

After installing, open Terminal (Mac) or Command Prompt (Windows) and check:

```
node --version    # you should see something like v20.11.0
npm --version     # you should see something like v10.2.0
```

2 Install VS Code — where you write the code

VS Code is a free app where you write and edit code. Go to code.visualstudio.com and install it like any normal app.

3 Install Vercel CLI — to put your site online for free

Vercel hosts your website for free. Run this one command in Terminal to install the deploy tool:

```
npm install -g vercel
```

TIP: The **-g** means "install globally" — so it works from any folder on your computer.

4 Create your project

Now create the project. In Terminal, go to Desktop and run these one by one:

```
cd Desktop                # go to Desktop
npm create vite@latest my-invite -- --template react
cd my-invite              # enter your project folder
npm install               # download base packages
code .                    # open VS Code here
```

TIP: **Vite** creates a ready-to-use React app. **React** is the technology behind this invite. Think of it as a blank canvas that is already wired up.

Install Libraries and Set Up Files

Libraries are extra tools other developers built that you can use for free.

5 Install the animation + icon libraries

Run this one command inside your project folder. It installs everything you need:

```
npm install framer-motion gsap lucide-react
```

framer-motion: Makes things move smoothly. The envelope opening, names sliding in, heart pulsing.

gsap: Another animation tool. Good for names sliding from the side and scroll-triggered animations.

lucide-react: Gives you ready-made icons — calendar, pin, clock, shirt icon.

6 Create your component files

Inside the **src** folder, create a folder called **components**. Then create these files inside it:

`src/components/EnvelopeIntro.jsx`

The first screen — tap to open

`src/components/HeroSlide.jsx`

Couple photo + animated names

`src/components/CountdownSlide.jsx`

Live countdown timer

`src/components/EventCards.jsx`

All 7 ceremony slides in one file

`src/components/FinalSlide.jsx`

The closing slide

7 Add your photos and music to the public folder

The **public** folder holds images and audio. Just drag and drop your files here:

```
public/
  couple.webp      <- main couple photo
  gondhal-bg.jpg   <- Gondhal ceremony photo
  mehendi-bg.jpg   <- Mehendi ceremony photo
  haldi-bg.jpg     <- Haldi ceremony photo
  wedding-bg.jpg   <- Wedding ceremony photo
  song-seal.mp3    <- music on the envelope screen
  song-inner.mp3   <- music inside the invite
  envelope-rk.png  <- your seal or logo image
```

index.css + App.jsx Basics

The CSS is critical. Get this wrong and nothing will work.

8 Replace all of src/index.css with this

This CSS stops the whole page from scrolling and limits the width to phone size (430px). Without this, the slide-snap effect breaks.

```
html, body {
  overflow: hidden !important;
  height: 100% !important;
}
#root {
  height: 100% !important;
  overflow: hidden !important;
  max-width: 430px;    /* phone width */
  margin: 0 auto;      /* center it on desktop */
}
.main-snap-container {
  scrollbar-width: none;
}
.main-snap-container::-webkit-scrollbar { display: none; }
```

TIP: overflow: hidden stops the page scrolling. All scrolling happens inside one special box. Think of it as: the window does not scroll — only the content inside the box does.

9 The snap container — the most important part of App.jsx

This one big box holds ALL your slides. It scrolls, and each slide snaps into place like a phone app:

```
<div
  className="main-snap-container"
  style={{
    position: "fixed",          /* covers full screen */
    top: 0, left: 0, right: 0, bottom: 0,
    maxWidth: "430px",
    margin: "0 auto",
    overflowY: "scroll",        /* only this box scrolls */
    scrollSnapType: "y mandatory", /* snap to slides */
  }}
>
  { /* put all slides here as direct children */ }
</div>
```

NOTE: Every slide inside must have **scrollSnapAlign: "start"** in its style. That tells the browser "snap here when scrolling." Like chapters in a book clicking into place.

EnvelopeIntro + HeroSlide

The first two things guests see when they open the link.

10 EnvelopeIntro.jsx — the tap-to-open screen

This is the very first screen. A floating image sits on a warm background. Guest taps it — the invite opens.

- Background: warm cream **#f5ece0**. The whole screen is this color.
- Image: your **/envelope-rk.png** file, about 230px wide, centered.
- Floating: Framer Motion moves it up and down forever — **animate={{ y: [0, -8, 0] }}**.
- On tap: mark invite as opened, start music, then after 400ms show the rest.
- On refresh: check sessionStorage so guests do not see the envelope again.

The tap function:

```
const handleOpen = () => {
  if (opened) return
  setOpened(true)
  onInteract?.() // start music — must happen on tap
  setTimeout(() => {
    sessionStorage.setItem("pv-invited", "true")
    onComplete() // shows the invite slides
  }, 400)
}
```

11 HeroSlide.jsx — couple photo with names

Full-screen couple photo. Groom name above, bride name below, with a golden line between them.

- Photo: **/couple.webp** as background. **objectFit: cover** fills the whole slide.
- Groom name: big italic font (Cormorant), size **clamp(52px, 14vw, 72px)**.
- GSAP on load: groom name slides from the left, bride name from the right.
- Top text "With Joyful Hearts..." sits at **paddingTop: 20vh**.
- Parallax: as you scroll down, the photo slowly moves too. Uses Framer Motion.

TIP: clamp(52px, 14vw, 72px) means: smallest 52px, ideally 14% of screen width, biggest 72px. It auto-sizes the text for any phone without you doing anything.

CountdownSlide + EventCards

A live timer and the ceremony slides.

12 CountdownSlide.jsx — live countdown timer

This slide shows how many days, hours, minutes, and seconds until the wedding. It ticks every second automatically.

```
// Change this to your wedding date and time:
const TARGET = new Date("2026-06-19T09:30:00+05:30")

useEffect(() => {
  const tick = () => {
    const diff = TARGET - new Date()
    setTime({
      days: Math.floor(diff / 86400000),
      hours: Math.floor((diff % 86400000) / 3600000),
      mins: Math.floor((diff % 3600000) / 60000),
      secs: Math.floor((diff % 60000) / 1000),
    })
  }
  tick() // run right away
  const id = setInterval(tick, 1000) // then every second
  return () => clearInterval(id) // stop when slide closes
}, [])
```

TIP: The date format is YYYY-MM-DDTHH:MM:SS+05:30. The +05:30 is Indian Standard Time. Just change the date and time, keep +05:30.

13 EventCards.jsx — all ceremony slides in one file

One file draws all your ceremony slides. You just fill in an array with your event details and it handles the rest:

```
const events = [
  {
    name: "Gondhal",
    label: "THE DIVINE BEGINNING",
    nameColor: "#f0c848", // color used for text + button
    date: "15 June 2026",
    time: "11:00 AM",
    venue: "Your Venue Name Here",
    dressCode: "Traditional",
    desc: "A short description of this ceremony.",
    mapsUrl: "https://maps.app.goo.gl/your-link",
  },
  // copy the block above for Mehendi, Haldi, etc.
]

const bgImages = ["/gondhal-bg.jpg", "/mehendi-bg.jpg", ...]
```

Music System + FinalSlide

Two songs, one mute button. The closing slide.

14 How the two-song system works

Song 1 plays on the envelope screen. Song 2 plays inside the invite. They switch automatically when the envelope opens.

NOTE: Important: Phones block music from auto-playing. Music can ONLY start when the user taps something. This is why we start it inside the tap function — not in a timer.

```
// Put these OUTSIDE the App function at the top of the file:
let sealAudio = null
let innerAudio = null

// Song 1 – envelope screen music:
useEffect(() => {
  if (inviteOpen) return
  sealAudio = new Audio("/song-seal.mp3")
  sealAudio.loop = true
  const start = () => sealAudio.play().catch(() => {})
  document.addEventListener("touchstart", start, { once: true })
}, [inviteOpen])

// Song 2 – invite music after envelope opens:
useEffect(() => {
  if (!inviteOpen) return
  if (sealAudio) { sealAudio.pause(); sealAudio = null }
  innerAudio = new Audio("/song-inner.mp3")
  innerAudio.loop = true
  innerAudio.play().catch(() => {})
}, [inviteOpen])
```

TIP: We use **let** variables (not React ref) for audio. This prevents a bug where React loses the reference to the audio object between re-renders.

15 FinalSlide.jsx — the closing slide

- Dark background with faint couple photo behind.
- Scrolling text at top — GSAP makes it slide left forever.
- Big couple names in cursive font: **"Groom and Bride"**.
- A pulsing gold heart — Framer Motion scale: [1, 1.3, 1] looping.
- Three info pills: date range, city, year.

Go Live on Vercel

Put your invite online. Free. Takes 2 minutes.

16 Sign up and log in to Vercel

Go to **vercel.com** and create a free account. Then connect it from Terminal:

```
vercel login    # opens browser — click confirm
```

17 Build your project

This converts your React code into files that browsers can understand:

```
npm run build
```

It creates a **dist** folder automatically. You do not need to touch it — Vercel uses it on its own.

18 Deploy (first time)

```
vercel --prod --yes --name my-wedding-invite

# Answer the questions:
#   Set up project?  -> press Y + Enter
#   Which account?   -> select your account
#   Link to project? -> press N (create new)

# Done! You get a link like:
#   https://my-wedding-invite.vercel.app
```

TIP: Copy that link and share it with guests. It works on any phone. No app needed. Just WhatsApp the link.

19 After any changes — push an update

Whenever you change something, run these two again:

```
npm run build
vercel --prod --yes
```

TIP: The second deploy is fast — it already knows your project. The link stays the same — guests do not need a new link.

Want one built for you?